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$$NO + O_3 \rightarrow NO_2 + O_2$$

$$O_2 \xrightarrow{h\upsilon} O + O$$

$$NO_2 + O \rightarrow NO + O_2$$

Thus NO is regenerated in the chain reaction.

Chloro Fluoro Carbons (CFC) Freons

The chloro fluoro derivatives of methane and ethane are referred by trade name Freons. These Chloro Fluoro Carbon compounds are stable, non-toxic, noncorrosive and non-inflammable, easily liquefiable and are used in refrigerators, air- conditioners and in the production of plastic foams. CFC's are the exhaust of supersonic air craft's and jumbo jets flying in the upper atmosphere. They slowly pass from troposphere to stratosphere. They stay for very longer period of 50 - 100 years. In the presence of uv radiation, CFC's break up into chlorine free radical

$$CF_2Cl_2 \xrightarrow{h\upsilon} CF_2Cl + Cl^{\cdot}$$

$$CFCl_3 \xrightarrow{h\upsilon} CFCl_2 + Cl^{\cdot}$$

$$Cl^{\cdot} + O_3 \rightarrow ClO + O_2$$

$$ClO^{\cdot} + O \rightarrow Cl + O_2$$

Chlorine radical is regenerated in the course of reaction. Due to this continuous attack of Cl˚ thinning of ozone layer takes place which leads to formation of ozone hole.

It is estimated that for every reactive chlorine atom generated in the stratosphere 1,00,000 molecules of ozone are depleted.

15.4.2 Environmental Impact of Ozone Depletion

The formation and destruction of ozone is a regular natural process, which never disturbs the equilibrium level of ozone in the stratosphere. Any change in the equilibrium level of the ozone in the atmosphere will adversely affect life in the biosphere in the following ways.

Depletion of ozone layer will allow more UV rays to reach the earth surface and layer would cause skin cancer and also decrease the immunity level in human beings.

UV radiation affects plant proteins which leads to harmful mutation of cells.

UV radiation affects the growth of phytoplankton, as a result ocean food chain is disturbed and even damages the fish productivity.

15.5 Water Pollution

Water is essential for life. Without water life would have been impossible. The slogan, 'Save Water, Water will save you' tell us the importance of water. Such slogans tell us to save water. Apart from saving water, maintaining its quality is also equally important.



Fig 15.6 water pollution

Now a days water is getting polluted due to human activities and the availability of potable water in nature is becoming rare day by day.Water pollution is defined as"The addition of foreign substances or factors like heat which degrades the